

CY376: NETWORK MONITORING, SECURITY AND AUDITING

End-of-Semester Project: Submission Guidelines

Milestone	Date	Notes
Printed report due	Monday, 3rd August	Bring it to the course office before close of business. See Section 1.5.
GitHub repo pushed	Monday, 3rd August	Your last commit needs a timestamp on or before this date. See Section 2.
Presentations and interviews	Start Tuesday, 4th August	A slot order goes up beforehand. Show up 15 minutes early. A random list of the presenters for the day will be provided a day in advance.

This project has three parts: a printed report, a pushed GitHub repository, and a ten-minute presentation followed by an interview. They're graded as one package, so don't treat any of them as an afterthought. Go through this document before your submission date, not after.

1. Written Report

1.1 Length and scope

Fifteen pages minimum, not counting the cover page, table of contents, or appendices. That's a floor, not a target to pad toward with oversized screenshots or filler paragraphs; graders can tell, and it costs you. The report should read like a month of work. If it reads like a weekend, that will be obvious too.

1.2 What the report needs to contain

Follow this order:

- Cover page: your name, index number, topic title, Blue Team or Red Team, course code, date.
- Abstract, about half a page: what the problem was, what you did, what you found.
- Table of contents with page numbers.
- Introduction: background and what the project set out to do.
- Literature and tooling review: the standards, frameworks, or tools that shaped your approach (MITRE ATT&CK, CIS Benchmarks, whatever applies).
- Methodology: your lab setup, a diagram of it, and the steps you actually took.
- Implementation: what you built, configured, deployed, or tested, with configuration excerpts where relevant.
- Results and findings: screenshots, logs, dashboards, scan outputs, or audit findings, each captioned and explained rather than dropped in without comment.

- Analysis and recommendations: what the results mean and what should change because of them.
- Conclusion: what came out of the month, in a few paragraphs.
- References, in one citation style used consistently (IEEE or APA, your choice).
- Appendices for full logs or extended code that would clutter the main body.

1.3 Formatting

Use an 11 or 12 point font (Calibri, Times New Roman, or Arial), 1.15 to 1.5 line spacing, and 1 inch margins. Number every page. Number and caption every figure and table, and refer to them by number in the text ("see Figure 4"). Screenshots should be cropped to the part that matters; a full screen capture with three toolbars and a cluttered desktop doesn't print well and doesn't help your grade. Redact anything sensitive, real IP addresses, credentials, personal data, if it shows up in a screenshot from a live system. Lab and simulated data throughout is the safer default.

1.4 Whose work this is

Do your own work. If two reports, or two repositories, look suspiciously alike in structure, wording, or code, both students get investigated under the academic integrity policy, not just one. If you build on top of someone else's tool, script, or template, say so and cite it. That's normal and fine; passing it off as entirely your own isn't.

1.5 Submitting the printed copy

Print one copy, bound or stapled, not loose sheets, and hand it to the course office or your instructor by close of business on Monday, 3rd August. If a digital copy is also requested, submit a PDF of the exact same report you printed, not a different draft, to whichever platform is designated.

2. GitHub Repository

2.1 What belongs in it

Everything behind the report: scripts, configuration files, IDS or SIEM rule sets, Dockerfiles, lab topology files, and any automation code or notes you produced along the way. Add a copy of the final report as a PDF, ideally in a docs or report folder.

If your topic is a Red Team one, keep it to proof-of-concept scripts and methodology notes. Nothing weaponized or intended for use outside the course lab, and no data captured from real systems that didn't consent to being tested.

2.2 Structure

- A README at the root: project title, a short summary, your name and index number, the tools you used, how to run it, and a link to (or copies of) your key screenshots.
- A sensible folder layout, for example src, configs, scripts, docs, evidence for logs and screenshots.
- A .gitignore that excludes secrets, credentials, large capture files, and virtual environment clutter.

- No API keys, passwords, personal data, or live target information anywhere in the history, not just the latest commit. Check your old commits too.

2.3 Commit history and the deadline

We're looking for commits spread across the month, not one bulk upload the night before submission. Your commit history is part of how this gets judged as real, ongoing work rather than something assembled at the last minute. The final commit needs to land on or before Monday, 3rd August, the same day as the printed report.

The repo can be public or private. If it's private, add the instructor as a collaborator before the deadline. Write the repo URL clearly on your cover page, and submit it through the online form as well if one is provided.

3. Presentation and Interview

Presentations and interviews start Tuesday, 4th August. A slot order goes up beforehand, and students go one at a time in that order.

3.1 The presentation: 10 minutes

Ten minutes, no more. Time yourself beforehand, because you'll be stopped when the clock runs out. A structure that tends to work: one slide on the problem or objective, one or two on your setup, three to five on results with actual evidence on screen, one on recommendations, one to close. Bring your slides on a laptop or a flash drive and get there 15 minutes early to set up.

Live demos are fine if you've tested them beforehand. If one fails on the day, switch to your screenshots or a recording rather than burning your ten minutes troubleshooting.

3.2 The interview

Right after you present, expect five to ten minutes of questions: why you made the choices you made, what your findings mean in practice, and what your commit history actually shows. You should be able to explain every command, script, or configuration in your report. If you can't explain it, we'll assume it isn't yours.

Bring your laptop with the repository open in case you're asked to walk through code live.

4. Before You Submit, Check This

- Fifteen pages of real content, bound or stapled, in the order laid out in Section 1.2.
- Every figure and screenshot is legible, captioned, and mentioned in the text.
- Anything sensitive in a screenshot has been redacted; lab or simulated data is used throughout.
- References use one citation style, consistently.
- The GitHub repo has your code, a full README, and a copy of the final report.
- Commit history spans the project period; it isn't one upload the night before.
- No secrets, credentials, or real third-party data anywhere in the repo, including old commits.
- Last commit is on or before 3rd August, and the repo URL is written on your cover page.
- You've timed your slides and they fit in 10 minutes.

- You can explain and defend every part of the work in the interview.

5. Late Work and Academic Integrity

Late reports or late pushes are only accepted with prior written permission for a documented emergency. Otherwise, the course's standard late penalty applies. Miss your presentation and interview slot without telling anyone beforehand, and it counts as a non-submission for that part.

Plagiarism, invented results, or passing off someone else's code as your own goes to the department under the academic integrity policy.

One more reminder from the topic list: Red Team work stays inside instructor-approved, isolated lab environments. Evidence of testing against real, unauthorized systems is treated as a serious violation, whatever the rest of the report looks like.